

Lab: Participatory Strategy Session

Objectives

Learning Goal: Experience and design a participatory planning process that harnesses collective intelligence for strategy development.

Part 1: Deliberate vs. Emergent Audit (10 min)

Compare your organization's stated strategy with its actual patterns of behavior:

Strategy Element	Deliberate (What's Planned)	Emergent (What Actually Happens)	Gap?
Key priorities			
Resource allocation			
New initiatives			
Decision-making			

Write your response here

Part 2: Bottom-Up Intelligence Collection (15 min, independent)

Each participant independently answers:

Question	Your View
What is the most important opportunity we're missing?	
What is the biggest risk we're not addressing?	
What customer need is underserved?	
What internal process is most broken?	
If you were CEO for a day, what would you change?	

Write your response here

Part 3: Aggregation and Prioritization (15 min, group)

Compile all individual inputs and identify patterns:

Theme	# of mentions	Consensus? (H/M/L)	Priority

Write your response here

Part 4: Strategy Proposal (15 min)

Based on the collective intelligence gathered, draft a strategy proposal:

Element	Proposal
Top strategic priority	
Key opportunity to pursue	
Risk to mitigate	
Resource reallocation needed	
How to monitor progress	

Write your response here

Part 5: Process Reflection (5 min)

Question	Reflection
Did the collective process surface insights that executive-only planning would miss?	
What was the most surprising input?	
How should this participatory process be integrated into regular planning?	

Write your response here

Summary

Finding	Detail
Biggest gap between deliberate and emergent strategy	
Most valuable bottom-up insight	
Top collectively-identified priority	
Recommended planning process change	